

POLITECNICO
MILANO 1863

RASD by Hamidreza Khodadadi and
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Requirement Analysis and Specification Document

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1 Introduction

1.1 Purpose

Urban cyclists often find it difficult to identify **safe, comfortable, and efficient routes** in their city. Information about bike lanes, traffic intensity, road quality, and obstacles (such as potholes or damaged surfaces) is usually incomplete, outdated, or scattered across many sources. At the same time, cyclists continuously generate valuable information while riding, such as GPS traces, speed profiles, and movements of their mobile devices, which typically remain unused. As a consequence, planning a pleasant and safe bike trip often relies on personal experience and trial-and-error, which may discourage people from using bikes as a regular means of transportation.

The **Best Bike Paths (BBP)** project aims to address these issues by providing a software system that helps cyclists **collect, maintain, and exploit an inventory of bike paths**. The system supports riders in recording their trips, annotating the quality of the paths they use, and reusing this knowledge to choose suitable routes between an origin and a destination. The ultimate purpose of BBP is to **enable cyclists to plan and perform safer and more effective bike trips** by relying on up-to-date, community-contributed information about bike paths. The purpose of the project is articulated into the following goals:

- **[G1 – Trip Recording]**

  Allow registered users to record their bike trips through a mobile device, capturing GPS traces and timestamps that describe the travelled route.

- **[G2 – Trip Statistics and History]**

  Provide users with statistics for each recorded trip (e.g., distance, duration, average speed) and maintain a personal history of their cycling activities, optionally enriched with relevant meteorological information, when available, from external services.

- **[G3 – Manual Path Definition]**

  Enable registered users to manually define bike paths by selecting streets or segments and associating them with properties such as path status (e.g., *optimal*, *medium*, *sufficient*, *requires maintenance*) and known obstacles (e.g., potholes, hazardous segments).

- **[G4 – Automated Path Data Acquisition]**

  Support an automated mode in which the system, while the user is biking, collects GPS data and sensor readings (accelerometer and gyroscope) to reconstruct the followed path and detect potential issues affecting path quality.

- **[G5 – Confirmation of Inferred Information]**

  Provide mechanisms for users to review, confirm, or correct the information inferred in automated mode (e.g., detected potholes), ensuring that only validated data becomes publishable.

- **[G6 – Path Inventory and Publication]**

  Maintain a structured inventory of bike paths and their associated information, and allow their owners to mark data as publishable so that it becomes available to all users of the system.

- **[G7 – Path Search and Visualization]**

  Allow users, including unregistered users, to request bike paths between a chosen origin and destination and visualize one or more candidate routes on a map.

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- **[G8 – Path Scoring and Recommendation]**

  Compute a score for each candidate path based on its status, obstacles, and effectiveness in reaching the destination from the origin, and use this score to rank alternative paths so that cyclists can easily choose the most suitable one.

Together, these goals define the purpose of BBP: **to turn cyclists' trips and feedback into actionable knowledge that improves the safety and quality of future bike routes.**

1.2 Scope

In the context of the *Best Bike Paths (BBP)* system, the relevant phenomena include:

1.2.1 World Phenomena

- **[WP1]**: Cyclists ride their bikes along existing streets and bike paths in the city, performing trips of varying duration and difficulty.
- **[WP2]**: The physical road infrastructure (streets, bike lanes, intersections) has properties such as surface quality, presence of potholes, and traffic intensity that may change over time.
- **[WP3]**: Weather conditions (e.g., rain, wind, temperature) influence the safety and comfort of cycling on given paths.
- **[WP4]:** Cyclists visually identify the status of the bike path (e.g., optimal, medium, sufficient).
- **[WP5]**: Cyclists plan journeys between an origin and a destination according to their own preferences (e.g., safety, comfort, travel time).
- **[WP6]**: Cyclists gain experience about the quality of the paths they use and may be willing to share this knowledge with others.

1.2.2 Shared Phenomena

World-Controlled Shared Phenomena:

- **[SP1]**: Users register to BBP, authenticate themselves, and manage their personal accounts through the application.
- **[SP2]**: Registered users start and stop the recording of their bike trips using their mobile devices.
- **[SP3]**: Users enable or disable the automated acquisition mode, granting or revoking permission for BBP to use location and motion sensors while they ride.
- **[SP4]**: Registered users manually define bike paths by selecting streets or segments in the application and assigning them a status and known obstacles.
- **[SP5]**: Users review, confirm, or correct information about path issues (e.g., potholes) that BBP has inferred from sensor data before this information becomes publishable.
- **[SP6]**: Users specify an origin and a destination and submit route queries to BBP.
- **[SP7]**: Users inspect the paths displayed by BBP on the map, compare alternatives, and choose which path to follow for their trip.

Machine-Controlled Shared Phenomena:

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- **[SP8]**: BBP records trip data (GPS positions, timestamps) and stores it as part of the user's trip history.
- **[SP9]**: BBP computes and presents statistics about each recorded trip, such as distance, duration, average speed, and similar indicators, possibly enriched with weather information obtained from external services.
- **[SP10]**: BBP reconstructs the path followed during a trip from GPS data and analyzes motion sensor readings to detect potential obstacles or surface problems.
- **[SP11]:** The system prompts the user to confirm or reject potential obstacles detected during the ride.
- **[SP12]**: BBP updates the inventory of bike paths with manually inserted or confirmed information, including path status and obstacles, and marks data as publishable or private according to the owner's choices.
- **[SP13]**: BBP processes a user's origin–destination query, selects candidate bike paths from the inventory, computes a score for each path based on its quality and effectiveness, and ranks them accordingly.
- **[SP14]**: BBP visualizes the selected paths on a map, together with their scores and relevant details, so that users can evaluate them.
- **[SP15]**: BBP enforces access control and privacy rules when returning trip and path information, exposing only what each user is allowed to see.
- **[SP16]:** The system sends requests to external map/weather APIs to retrieve necessary environmental context.

1.3 Definitions, Acronyms, Abbreviations

This section introduces the terminology used throughout the document. Its aim is to avoid ambiguity and to ensure consistent usage of terms.

1.3.1 Definitions

- **Bike Path:** A route intended to be suitable for bicycles, either because a proper bike lane exists or because traffic conditions (e.g., low car density, compatible speed limits) make the road appropriate for cycling.
- **Path Segment:** A portion of a bike path corresponding, for example, to a single street or a continuous stretch of roadway between two intersections.
- **Trip:** A cycling activity performed by a registered user and recorded by BBP, including the start and end times of the activity and associated statistics such as total distance and average speed.
- **Trip Point (GPS Sample):** A single geolocated point acquired during a trip, consisting of a timestamp and coordinates (latitude and longitude). Trip points form the sequence used by BBP to reconstruct the followed path.
- **Trip Statistics:** Quantitative metrics computed by BBP for a trip, such as total distance, duration, elevation trends, and average speed.

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- **Meteorological Information / Weather Condition:** Weather-related data associated with a trip (e.g., temperature, wind speed, precipitation, general weather conditions) retrieved from an external service.
- **Obstacle:** A relevant issue affecting a bike path, such as a pothole, rough surface, or other road-surface irregularity. Obstacles may be manually reported by users or created automatically after the confirmation of detected issues.
- **Detected Issue:** A potential obstacle inferred automatically by BBP from device sensor data (e.g., accelerometer, gyroscope) acquired during a trip. Each detected issue includes a type, location, and confidence level and must be confirmed, corrected, or rejected by the user.
- **Path Status:** A qualitative evaluation of the overall condition of a bike path (e.g., optimal, medium, sufficient, requires maintenance).
- **Manual Mode:** A mode in which registered users explicitly insert information about bike paths, selecting the streets composing the path and setting their status and known obstacles.
- **Automated Mode:** A mode in which BBP acquires data automatically from the user's mobile device while they are biking. The system infers that the user is biking based on speed, reconstructs the followed path using GPS data, and detects possible obstacles using accelerometer and gyroscope measurements.
- **Confirmation Phase:** A phase following automated acquisition in which the user is asked to confirm, correct, or discard issues inferred by BBP before this information becomes available to the community.
- **Publishable Information:** Information about bike paths provided to BBP (either manually or automatically) that the owner chooses to make available to all users of the system.
- **Registered User:** A user who has an account on BBP and can record trips, insert information about bike paths, confirm automatically detected issues, and publish information.
- **Non-Registered User:** A user who accesses BBP without logging in and can only request the visualization of bike paths between an origin and a destination.
- **Origin:** The starting geographic point of a route specified by the user in a route search query.
- **Destination:** The target geographic point of a route specified by the user in a route search query.
- **Route Query:** A request made by a user to BBP specifying an origin and a destination for which the system must visualize one or more bike paths.
- **Candidate Path:** A bike path evaluated by BBP in response to a route query. For each candidate path, BBP computes a score and displays it as one of the possible routes.
- **Path Score:** A numerical or ordinal value computed by BBP for a bike path based on the path's status, presence of obstacles, and overall effectiveness in reaching the destination from the given origin.

1.3.2 Acronyms

- **BBP**: Best Bike Paths.
- **GPS**: Global Positioning System.
- **RASD**: Requirements Analysis and Specification Document.

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- **UI**: User Interface.
- **API**: Application Programming Interface.

The acronyms UI and API are used in later sections of this document to describe external interfaces and are therefore listed here for completeness.

1.3.3 Abbreviations

- **DB**: Database.
- **ID**: Identifier.
- **Avg.**: Average (e.g., Avg. speed).
- **Min.**: Minimum.
- **Max.**: Maximum.

1.4 Revision History

Version	Date	Author(s)	Description
0.1	2025-11-22	Mohammad Rashidkhan	Prepare Introduction draft and add Purpose and Scope sections.
0.2	2025-11-23	Hamidreza Khodadadi	Add Definitions, Acronyms, Abbreviations, Reference and Structure sections.

Table 1: Revision history of the RASD.

1.5 Reference Documents

This document is based on the following material:

- The official RASD assignment specification for the Software Engineering 2 course, academic year 2025–2026, containing the problem definition “Best Bike Paths”.
- Slides and notes from the Software Engineering 2 course concerning requirements engineering and the preparation of RASD documents.

1.6 Document Structure

- **Section 1 – Introduction**: presents the purpose and scope of BBP, defines key terminology (definitions, acronyms, abbreviations), and reports revision history, reference documents, and the structure of this RASD.
- **Section 2 – Overall Description**: provides a high-level view of the BBP system, including the product perspective, main functions, user characteristics, assumptions, dependencies, and constraints.
- **Section 3 – Specific Requirements**: details the functional and non-functional requirements of BBP, including external interface requirements, use cases and related diagrams, performance requirements, design constraints, and software system attributes.
- **Section 4 – Formal Analysis Using Alloy**: presents the formal model of selected aspects of BBP and the results of analyses performed using the Alloy tool.

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- **Section 5 – Effort Spent**: summarizes the amount of work carried out by each group member for the preparation of this document.
- **Section 6 – References**: lists all external sources referenced in this RASD.

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